



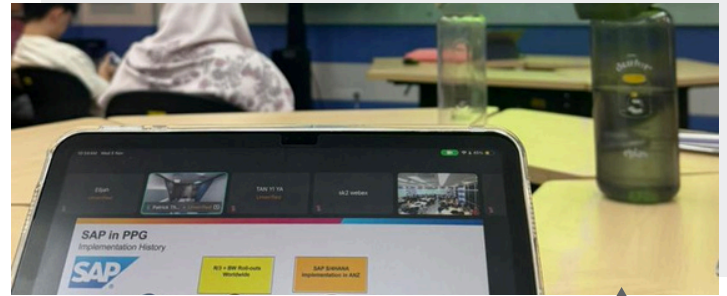
INDUSTRIAL TALK

05 NOV 2025 | 10:00 AM

SUMMARY OF THE TALK

On November 5 2025, SECP3744 Enterprise System and Design Modelling students provided a unique industry talk with Patrick Thong, head of PPG SAP CoE Operation Process in the Asia-Pacific region. The speech fully explained Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP), a software solution that helps organisations simplify their basic business activities such as finance, production and supply chain into a unified system that provides a single real source. The talk focuses on the market-leading ERP software SAP and how PPG, a global company, develops and operates this powerful technology.

A big part of the talk was about PPG's "Connect PPG" project. This is a huge and multi-year plan to upgrade all of their computer systems. They are moving from an older SAP system ECC 6.0 to a brand new one called S/4HANA. The main goal is to get all of PPG's offices around the world to use the same system. After migration, all their information is in one single and trusted place. This big upgrade started in 2018 in Australia and is happening in Europe and Asia in 2025.



*source: Image taken by Elijah She Yu Sheng

TECHNOLOGIES AND TIPS DISCUSSED

Mr. Thong explained that SAP is not just a program, but it is composed of many modules. Each module does a specific job. For example, in PPG, MM and PP modules are helpful in managing factories such as purchasing materials and planning production. The SD module is responsible for selling and delivering to customers. FI and CO modules manage all the company's funds, such as paying bills and tracking profits.

When asked which SAP modules are the best to learn, Mr. Thong said that they are equally important because they all deal with the key parts of the business. He suggested that we study different parts of the program openly, because flexibility will make you a more valuable employee.

Mr. Thong said that for students who want to do internships, you don't need to know SAP. He said that the most important things that managers are looking for are curious mind, enthusiasm for learning, proactiveness and strong professional ethics. PPG helps interns learn by visiting the Udemy website for free. However, official and expensive SAP certification is usually reserved for full-time employees who show seriousness.



REFLECTION

From this talk, I learned that the company's attitude towards interns is innovative. In the Q&A session, Mr. Thong clarified that internship does

not require you to have SAP technical knowledge in advance which inspired me. On the other hand, the company prioritises curious mind, enthusiasm for learning and strong professional ethics over anything else. PPG shows that a person's willingness to learn is more valuable than their previous knowledge by providing learning resources such as Udemy to all employees and committing to teaching skills at work. This talk is valuable for me, and SAP feel much more approachable, even for new graduates. This gives me confidence that I can succeed in a company that emphasises employee development.

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From the PPG talk, I've gained a clear view of how Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) works in a global setting and how it connects core business activities like finance, production, and supply chain into a single and trusted source. Besides that, I also learned that PPG is currently upgrade their systems from the older SAP ECC 6.0 to the brand new S/4HANA through "Connect PPG" project. This is to combine all of PPG's global offices onto this single system, with its deployments currently taking place in Europe and Asia in 2025. Lastly, the speaker explained that SAP is composed of many modules with each doing a specific job. For example, the MM and PP modules manage factories, materials purchasing, and production planning, while the SD module handles sales and customer delivery. Overall, this talk is very productive and will help me for my employment in industry in the future.

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